

Stories built with care, not just code.



The expanded public guide to the product idea, demonstrated foundation, Sprint 1 boundary, roadmap, design philosophy, and visual recipe.

VERIFIED + CANDID

15 PAGES

A curated project story - not a live export of private work.

The foundation passed. The family boundary comes next.

Sprint 0 was demonstrated on September 2, 2026. Sprint 1 is now the active planning boundary - not a claim that every account or parent-mode task is already complete.

OUTCOME DEMONSTRATED

Sprint 0

Clean React and .NET foundations, documentation, contracts, dependency checks, CI, and browser evidence passed one recorded outcome gate.

ACTIVE PLANNING BOUNDARY

Sprint 1

The accepted account, child-mode, parent-mode, and evidence boundaries are documented. Work becomes ready only when dependencies and acceptance evidence are clear.

The project measures progress by demonstrated family outcomes, not issue count, elapsed calendar time, or optimistic labels.

A parent turns care into a story a child can enjoy.

Tiny Custom Stories aims to make personalized learning playful and understandable while keeping the technology bounded and worthy of family trust.

ROLE 1

Parents lead

Parents choose the purpose, guide creation, review drafts, and decide what a child can read.

ROLE 2

Children receive wonder

The first audience is ages two through six, reading with a parent or independently from an approved library.

ROLE 3

AI assists

AI can help plan words and pictures. It does not become the hero, the parent, or an unexplained authority.

The intended value is not more content. It is a meaningful family story shaped around a purpose: morals and values, fun and fantasy, or reading development.

Small enough to understand. Complete enough to learn from.

The Alpha is deliberately narrow. Confirmed scope, deferred ideas, and unresolved work are kept separate.

ACCEPTED

Confirmed Alpha shape

- Website first
- Ages two through six
- One parent, one family, one child
- Cover plus ten illustrated pages
- Parent-led guided creation
- Approved child-visible library

DEFERRED, NOT REJECTED

Explicitly later

- Native app
- Narration and video
- Public marketplace
- Account credits
- Multiple children or caregivers
- Unreviewed story export

A completed sprint is a demonstrated outcome.

Sprint 0 passed only after the same identified foundation was checked locally and in continuous integration, with unresolved risks carried forward rather than hidden.

01 Buildable foundations

React/Vite and ASP.NET Core foundations build and test without restoring the retired applications.

02 Contracts

The checked-in API contract reproduces deterministically and agrees with runtime behavior.

03 Quality gates

Formatting, linting, types, analyzers, Release builds, unit tests, and dependency thresholds passed.

04 Browser evidence

A controlled Chromium journey and reviewed artifacts showed the web and API foundations working together.

05 Clean hand-off

No remaining Sprint 0 must-have work remained when the gate was recorded.

Seven outcomes. No invented delivery dates.

The sequence is a revisable planning proposal. The rule that each sprint must demonstrate its outcome before transition is an accepted decision.

00	Foundation	COMPLETE
01	Accounts + parent mode	ACTIVE
02	Child Map + lifecycle	PROPOSED
03	Text story slice	PROPOSED
04	Characters + art	PROPOSED
05	Library + reader	PROPOSED
06	Alpha readiness	PROPOSED

A shared device needs two honest modes.

The outcome is safe movement between a child-facing library and a protected parent workspace, enforced by the server as well as represented in the interface.

BOUNDARY 1

Child mode

Default after sign-in. Read-only. Approved stories and ordinary reading navigation only.

BOUNDARY 2

Parent mode

Deliberate adult entry for family context, creation, review, visibility, settings, and account work.

BOUNDARY 3

Stronger moments

Recovery, complete export, and account deletion require stronger email re-verification.

BOUNDARY 4

Safe return

Exit, expiry, or tab closure returns to child mode and conceals private work.

The boundary has to survive the awkward moments.

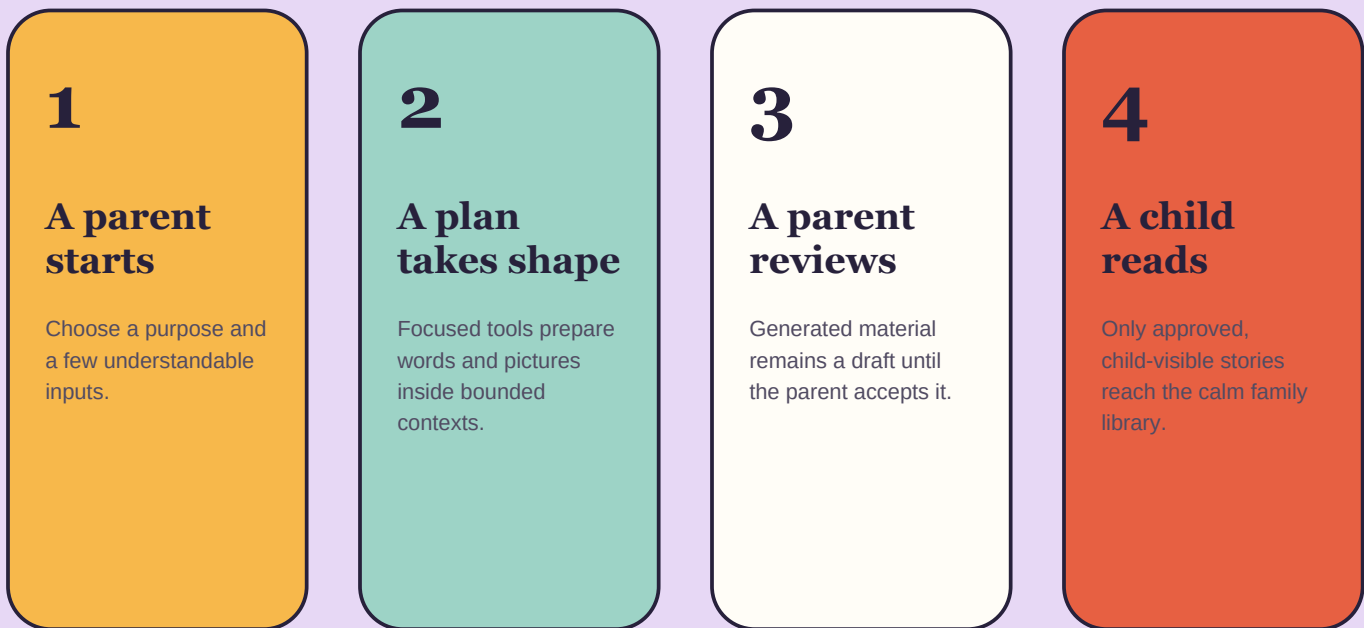
A happy-path sign-in is not enough. Sprint 1 evidence covers authorization, failure, recovery, expiry, refresh, isolation, accessibility, and the full return to child mode.

- 01 First and repeat sign-in preserve one family boundary
- 02 Child mode cannot read parent data or call protected APIs
- 03 Parent entry, failure, throttling, reset, and explicit exit
- 04 Expiry, refresh, tab isolation, and concealed private drafts
- 05 Stronger checks for recovery, export, and deletion
- 06 Keyboard, focus, announcements, reflow, and error recovery
- 07 Synthetic browser journey from sign-in back to child mode

Public summary only: operational security parameters and private project links are intentionally omitted.

A few important hand-offs keep people in charge.

The primary creation direction is a guided form, not a blank AI prompt. The detailed four-section builder and draft-editing behavior remain proposals that need prototype evidence.



Personalization should use the minimum relevant family context. More data is not automatically a better story.

The why behind every screen, service, and hand-off.

Design includes language, hierarchy, interaction, system feedback, accessibility, privacy, safety, failure handling, architecture boundaries, and honest documentation.

Human intention leads

AI assists inside parent-led purpose and review.

Two modes, not one compromise

Child and parent needs, density, and authority remain distinct.

Calm over capture

No attention traps, autoplay, streaks, or artificial urgency.

Warmth with clarity

Character supports meaning instead of competing with it.

Trust is visible

Privacy, uncertainty, drafts, progress, and limits appear where they matter.

Every state is designed

Loading, empty, interruption, error, expiry, recovery, and return all count.

Accessibility is structural

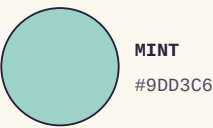
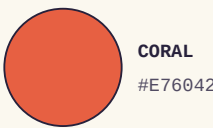
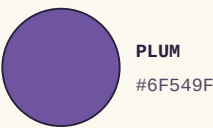
Semantics, focus, contrast, reflow, alternatives, and reduced motion begin early.

Evidence outranks taste

Synthetic inspected evidence decides whether confidence is deserved.

Paper, ink, and a few purposeful sparks.

The paper-and-ink story studio turns philosophy into a reproducible visual language for agents and surfaces.



Display: Fraunces 500-700. Body and controls: Nunito Sans 500-800. Metadata: DM Mono 400-500. This PDF uses the accepted Georgia, Helvetica, and Courier fallbacks when the web fonts are unavailable.

Creative references become general qualities - candid language, simple explanatory drawings, warmth, and human imperfection - never copied lettering, characters, compositions, or signature style.

One family of surfaces. Four different responsibilities.

Shared foundations create recognition. The audience, density, authority, and seriousness of the moment determine the theme.

CHILD LIBRARY + READER

Storybook light

Large concrete controls, cover-led color, stable navigation.

PROTECTED PARENT WORK

Guided studio

Quiet forms, privacy context, recoverable work, explicit approvals.

THIS PUBLIC STORY

Public editorial

Large type, generous space, status labels, original diagrams.

SECURITY + DELETION

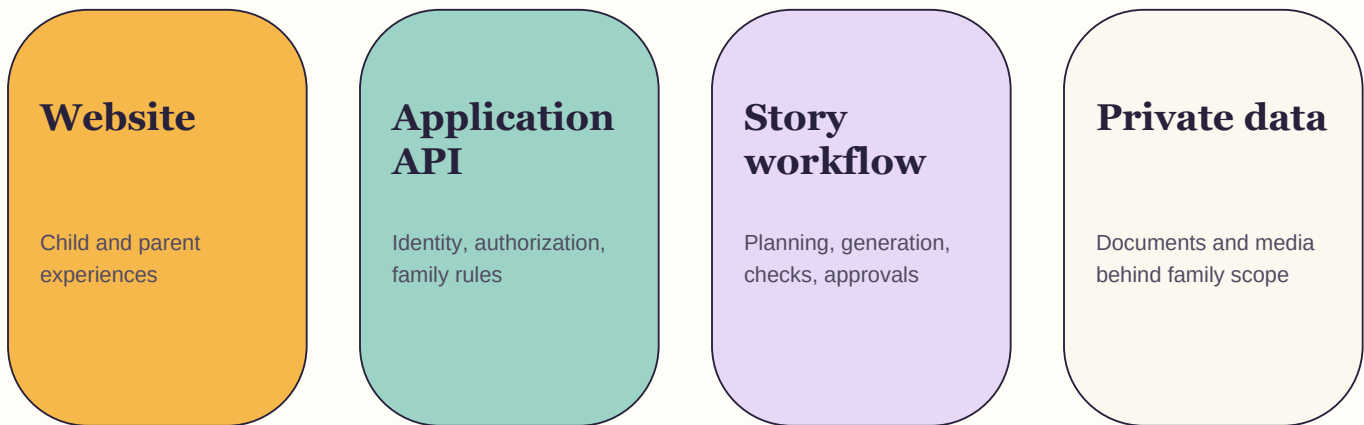
Serious

Plain language, stable geometry, restrained color, no playful treatment.

Buttons use verb-led labels, strong focus, minimum target sizes, and complete loading, active, disabled, and error behavior. Decorative warmth disappears around consent, security, deletion, and critical failure.

Focused boundaries make creative systems easier to question.

The target is not one giant application or one all-purpose AI context. Product responsibilities stay separate enough to meter, test, replace, and explain.



Provider rule

Text and image providers are evaluated separately with synthetic evidence for data use, retention, regions, deletion, safety, quality, cost, reliability, and exit. No provider is selected merely because an adapter can call it.

Confirmed foundations include React/Vite, ASP.NET Core, Clerk behind an application-owned identity boundary, MongoDB for documents, and private S3-compatible media storage. Detailed deployment and workflow products still have open decisions.

Useful unknowns stay visible.

An open question is not a hidden commitment or a defect in the foundation. It is a named place for research, prototype evidence, qualified review, or a founder decision.

Q01

What family information is necessary, optional, or prohibited?

Q02

Which requests and generated content must the platform prevent?

Q03

How should parents edit, regenerate, report, or reject AI output?

Q04

Which text and image providers meet the evidence bar?

Q05

What proves the private Alpha is valuable and safe enough to continue?

Q06

What visual and safety system should guide story illustrations?

Keep the work small enough to prove and honest enough to change.

The near-term work is not one giant feature. It is a set of focused decisions, contracts, controls, interfaces, failure states, tests, and evidence that together demonstrate Sprint 1.

FOCUSED WORK

Account boundary

Create and resume one internal family only after verified sign-in.

FOCUSED WORK

Child-safe default

Open into the approved library and reject parent-only API access.

FOCUSED WORK

Protected entry

Implement parent verification, expiry, refresh, isolation, and safe return.

FOCUSED WORK

Evidence journey

Demonstrate the complete synthetic browser path with accessibility states.

Source trail: Alpha scope; Sprint 0 outcome demonstration; Alpha roadmap; Sprint 1 account and protected-parent-mode specification; decision log through DEC-2026-027; open questions; design philosophy; visual design language; and public project-story curation guidance.

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